

Ternstroemia subsessilis

no common name – a shrub or small tree

Family (Pentaphylacaceae)

Kingdom (Plantae)

Status (Endangered)

Description

An evergreen shrub or small tree that can reach up to 5 m in height. It has alternate, thick leaves that are obovate to oblanceolate, with a cuneate base and an obtuse or slightly pointed apex, and a punctate lower surface. The flowers are solitary, actinomorphic, and appear sessile due to a very short pedicel, with five glandular sepals, five white petals, and numerous stamens. The fruit is an ovoid-conical capsule about 10 mm long with a sharp tip.



Location/Habitat



Found in the Luquillo Mountains of Puerto Rico, within the Caribbean National Forest. It occurs in both the palo colorado forest (above 600 m) and the dwarf (elfin) forest (above 750 m), on steep, acidic soils in high-elevation mountainous terrain.